

4.4 Removing Adware And Spyware

If you've been regularly downloading and installing freeware or shareware applications, chances are your computer is infected. The same goes for clicking on pop-up ads or banners, or using P2P clients.



Trend Micro offers a free online spyware scanner

There are several trustworthy services that can scan your computer online. Trend Micro's House Call (www.trendmicro.com/hc_intro/default.asp) is one such offering. It scans your computer for not only spyware and adware but viruses as well.

Identifying spyware and adware is the easy part; getting it off your computer is the tough bit. Spyware is intended to be difficult to find and not very easy to remove. Most spyware are hidden in a variety of directories on your computer—removing them is really not as easy as using your Add/Remove Programs applet. It is made tougher still by the fact that some of these applications come bundled with freeware and shareware applications, and removing the adware can disable the functionality